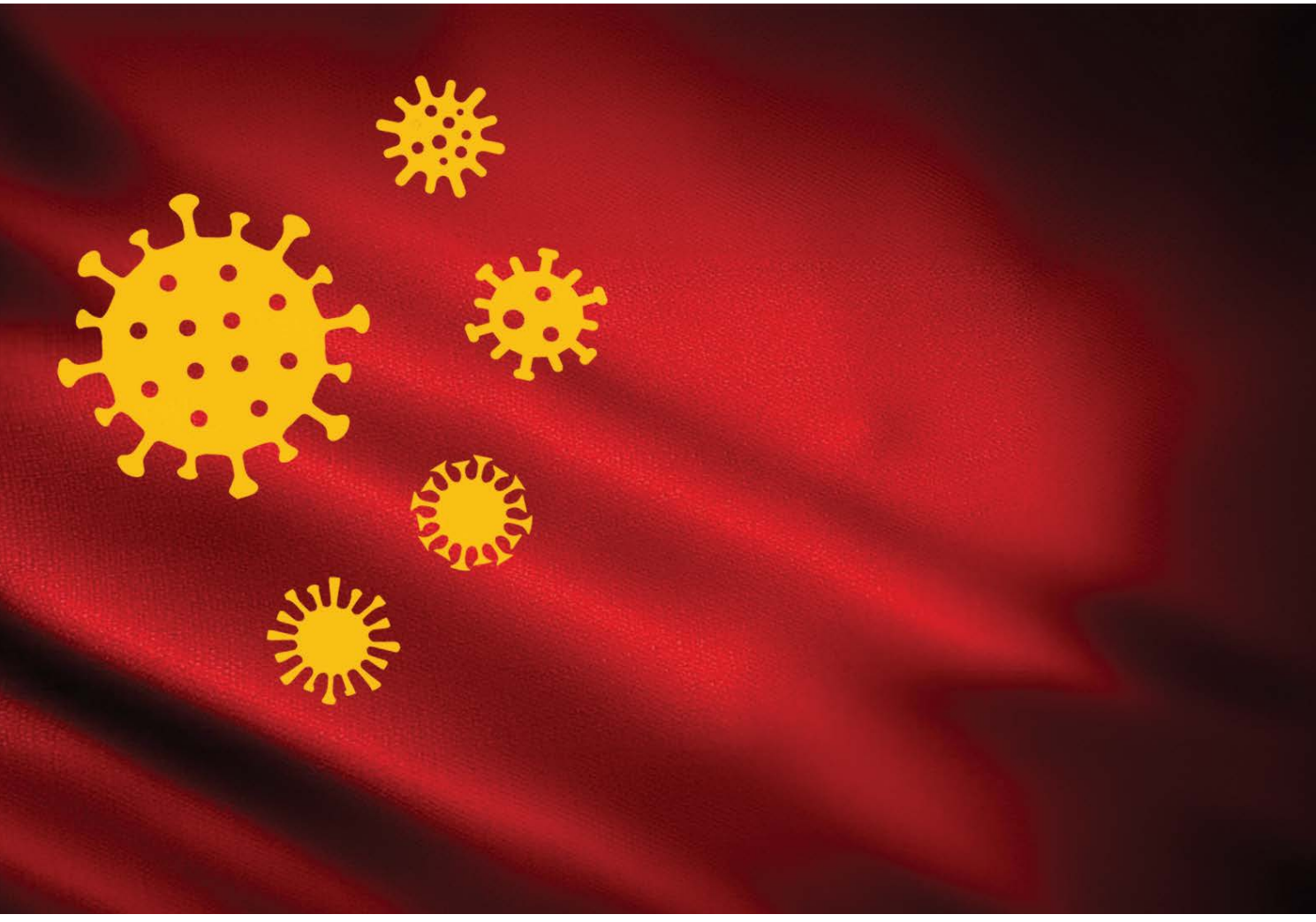
BENGAL: MAMATA'S BORDER OUTBURST PG 9

GRAPHIC: THE NEW DATA RULES PG 12

UPFRONT

BIHAR: LALU'S OLIVE BRANCH GAMBIT PG 11

SIKKIM: MAPPING THE MOODS OF LAKES PG 14



HMPV

VIRAL FEAR RISES ANEW

By Sonali Acharjee

The fear is not an irrational one—it's just the other day that the spectre of Covid-19 was harassing the whole world. So as China reports a spike in respiratory illnesses, the memories of planetary disruption have come rushing back. Beijing dismisses the growing number of Influenza A, Human metapneumovirus (hMPV), Mycoplasma pneumoniae and Covid-19 cases as a routine "winter occurrence" and withholds an official count. But tiny warning bells are beginning to ring everywhere, including in India. While all these infections are indeed seasonal, reports on social media and from medical facilities suggest a significant outbreak of multiple microbes in China, and a newsworthy level of burden on the country's healthcare system. The usual winter illnesses are suddenly beginning to look a trifle unusual.

If it's any consolation, none of these

Illustration by NILANJAN DAS